

Install, sign in, first session

Module 2 · running and driving a session

Lab: L01 First session and memory

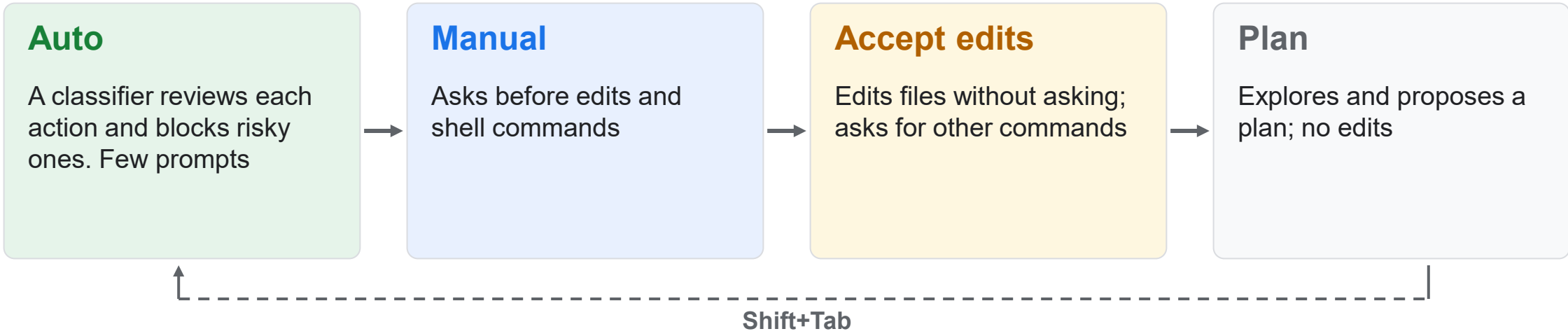
OBJECTIVES

What you will be able to do

- Install Claude Code and confirm it works
- Sign in with your seat, and know when an API key takes over
- Start a session in VS Code and in a terminal
- Know which permission mode you start in, and switch it
- Give a prompt with file references, steer it, resume it
- Read a tool call and answer an approval prompt

Which mode you start in

New interactive sessions start in Auto mode (v2.1.283 or later). Press Shift+Tab to cycle; VS Code has a mode indicator under the prompt box.



For your first lab, press Shift+Tab once to switch to Manual. You see every approval prompt and learn what Claude is about to do. Modes in depth: M8.

2.8 · STEERING

Steering while it works

M01: you are part of the loop. These are the keys.

YOU WANT TO	DO THIS
Stop right now	Esc
Add a correction	Type it and press Enter while Claude works. It is queued and read as soon as the current tool calls finish
Go back and undo	Esc twice on an empty prompt (M4)
Pause and look at the project	Stop, run what you need, then continue the conversation

You do not need a perfect prompt. Start with the goal, then refine in the next message. You are delegating, not dictating.

Approval prompts

In Manual mode, a shell command shows a prompt like this (Auto mode asks far less often).

1	**Yes**	Allow this one time. Press Tab to add a note for Claude
2	**Yes, and don't ask again**	Shell commands and web domains: saved for this repository in .claude/settings.local.json. File edits: until the session ends
3	**Yes, and switch to auto mode**	Approves and moves the session to Auto. Not on every prompt
4	**No**	Refuse. Press Tab to add a reason; Claude reads it and continues

⚠ **No without a note stops the turn. "Don't ask again" for shell commands is permanent: use it only for safe commands like the test run, never for rm or git push.**

Essential commands

COMMAND	DOES
`/help`	Show help and commands
`/status`	Version, model, account, connectivity, settings sources
`/model`	Choose the model
`/clear`	New conversation with empty context. The old one stays in /resume
`/resume`	Pick an earlier conversation
`/usage`	Session cost, plan limits
`/config`	Settings panel: update channel, theme, and more
`/doctor`	Checkup of install, settings and instruction files, with fixes
`/login, /logout`	Account

Type / to filter the list. A command is recognised only at the start of your message. Others are taught with their modules.

REFERENCE

Install checks

INSTALL CHECKS

```
claude --version      e.g. 2.1.211 (Claude Code)
claude doctor         install and settings diagnostics, last update
claude update         update now
where claude          Windows: path of the binary
which claude          macOS / Linux
```

If claude --version works, it is installed. If where / which shows nothing, it is not on your PATH: open a new terminal, then run claude doctor.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Question 1

You installed Claude Code and typing claude says "not recognised". What do you try first?

Think first, then we discuss.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Question 2

ANTHROPIC_API_KEY is set on your machine and you approved it at the first prompt. Which account pays?

Think first, then we discuss.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Question 3

The VS Code extension is installed but claude is not found in the integrated terminal. Why?

Think first, then we discuss.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Question 4

Your first session runs a dozen commands and you never see an approval prompt. Why, and how do you see them?

Think first, then we discuss.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Question 5

You pick "No" on an approval prompt and add the note "use the test file instead". What happens?

Think first, then we discuss.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Question 6

What is the difference between /clear and claude -c?

Think first, then we discuss.